

Common Application | Undergraduate

Drew Young | CAID: APP_012 | Fall 2026

Applicant information

App ID	APP_012
First Name	Drew
Last Name	Young
Date Of Birth	4/28/08
Mailing Address	1011 Sample Avenue, Madison, WI 53703
Primary Phone Number	608-555-0111
Email Address	drew.young.012@example.com
Gender	Male
Ethnicity	Asian
Country	USA
Region	Midwest

Education and application details

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Name of HS	Madison High School
Counselor Name	Finley Nguyen
Intended Major	Biomedical Engineering
Admission Year	2026
Admission Term	F
Unweighted GPA	3.97
Weighted GPA	4.4
Rank	Not provided
Superscored SAT Score	1530
Superscored ACT Score	35

AP Courses

AP Human Geography, AP Chemistry, AP Comparative Government, AP Computer Science A, AP Physics C Electricity and Magnetism, AP Macroeconomics, AP Calculus AB, AP Seminar, AP Art History, AP Physics 1, AP French Language, AP English Literature

Total APs

12

IB Courses

Not provided

Total IBs

Not provided

Activities

Varsity soccer player, School art club member, Environmental club volunteer, Youth orchestra musician, Science club member, Community food bank volunteer, Library volunteer, Animal shelter volunteer

Awards

MVP

Hooks

international student on visa

Personal essay

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Prompt: Describe an experience that changed how you think or learn.

The second version

During a science club discussion, I drew a device that seemed efficient on paper. A classmate asked how a person with limited hand movement would use it. I had designed around the mechanism and forgotten the person. That question changed the drawing more than any calculation did.

My first response was to make the problem smaller than it really was. I wanted a neat explanation and a quick result. When that did not work, I felt embarrassed by how much I had assumed. Looking back, the useful part of the experience began when I admitted that I needed more information. I wrote down what I knew, what I was guessing, and what I still needed to ask. That simple separation helped me move forward without pretending to be certain.

The next attempt was slower. I listened to another perspective, changed one part of my approach, and checked whether the change made sense. I learned that revision is more than replacing a wrong answer with a right one. Sometimes it means changing the question itself. I also learned to explain my choices clearly enough that someone else could challenge them. An idea became more useful when it could survive a conversation rather than only look convincing in my notebook.

That lesson has followed me into ordinary parts of my school life. When I do not understand a reading, I try to identify the sentence where I lost the argument. When a group disagrees, I ask what each person is trying to accomplish. These habits do not solve every problem, and I still sometimes rush toward an answer. But they give me a way to begin again. I am becoming more comfortable saying that I have not figured something out yet, provided that I can describe the next step I will take.

My interest in Biomedical Engineering comes partly from this experience. I want to study how ideas meet the complicated conditions of actual lives. I hope college will give me stronger methods, unfamiliar perspectives, and people who will question my assumptions. I do not expect every class to confirm the direction I have chosen. I want some of them to make me reconsider it. Learning should enlarge the questions I can ask as well as the answers I can offer.

The lesson I carry with me is to test an idea with the people who will use it. It sounds modest, but it changes how I work. I now see patience, curiosity, and a willingness to revise as practical responsibilities. I want to contribute to a college community by taking other people seriously, making my reasoning clear, and continuing when a first attempt fails. The moment that matters most to me is no longer the moment I can announce an answer. It is the moment I understand enough to take a more thoughtful next step.

Essay is fictional and generated for this prototype. It is embedded in this CommonApp document.